PART II · TIME · 8

# Repeats and road signs

Music often says “play that again”. Instead of writing the same bars twice, it uses **repeat signs** and **road signs**. Read them like a map: they tell you which bar comes next.

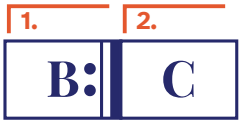
THE SECRET

**Follow the map: jump back at the sign, stop at Fine, or jump to the Coda.**




**You play: A → B → A → B → C**

*Two dots facing back mean: go back and play it again*

| SIGN | NAME | WHAT YOU DO |
|---|---|---|
|  | **repeat signs** | play the bars between them twice (with only the end sign: go back to the start) |
|  | **1st and 2nd time bars** | first time play the 1. bar; after the repeat skip it and play the 2. bar |
| **D.C.** | **da capo** | “from the head”: go back to the very beginning |
|  | **D.S.** (dal segno) | “from the sign”: go back to the segno |
| **Fine** | **fine** | “the end”: after a D.C. or D.S., stop here |
|  | **coda** | “tail”: at “To Coda”, jump to the coda sign and play the ending |

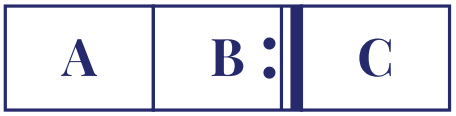
THE RULE

**Follow the map in order. At a jump (D.C., D.S.) go back; then the first time you meet Fine, stop; or at To Coda, jump to the coda.**

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EXAMPLE 1

**In what order do you play these bars?**



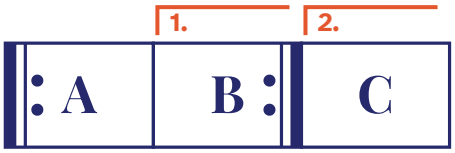

**You play:** ? ? ? ? ?

1. **Play A and B.**
2. **B ends with a repeat sign** facing back. There is no start sign: where do you go back to?
3. **Play it again,** then carry on.

Back to the very start: **A B A B C**.

EXAMPLE 2

**First and second time**




**You play:** ? ? ? ?

1. **First time through:** play A, then the bar marked 1.
2. **The repeat sign** sends you back to A.
3. **Second time:** which bar do you skip, and which do you play?

A B, A C: **A B A C**. The 1. bar is skipped the second time.

GAME

**How many bars do you play?**

| 1 | 2 | 3 |
|---|---|---|
| \|: A B :\| | A \|: B C :\| D | A B (Fine) C D.C. |

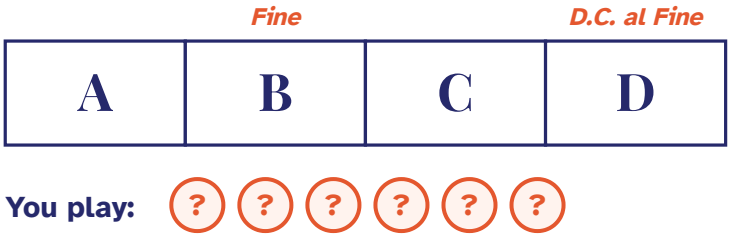
Each letter is one bar. Follow the signs and count every bar you play.

Answer: 1 four (A B A B) · 2 six (A B C B C D) · 3 five (A B C A B).

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EXAMPLE 3

**D.C. al Fine**

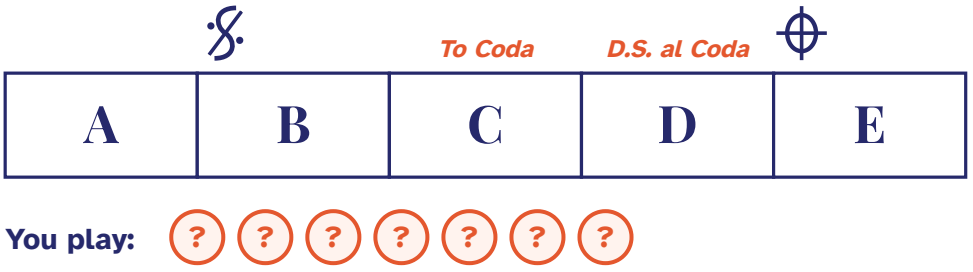



1. **Play straight through** to D.
2. **D.C.** means go back: to where?
3. **al Fine:** where do you stop the second time?

A B C D, then from the head to Fine: **A B C D A B**.

EXAMPLE 4

**D.S. al Coda**




1. **Play through** to D. (Ignore "To Coda" the first time.)
2. **D.S.** sends you back to the sign: which bar has it?
3. **Play on to "To Coda",** then jump. Where?

A B C D, back to the sign, B C, jump to the coda: **A B C D B C E**.

TRAP

- × Taking the repeat again after a D.C.: on the way back, skip the repeats (unless the music says otherwise).
- × Jumping at "To Coda" the first time through: it only works after the D.S. or D.C.

SEE ALSO
Pulse and the bar p. 50 · Time signatures p. 59

PRACTISE IT
Online: Library › Signs